

YEAR 10 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 6 · GENERATION GAP

Reading

B1+/B2

The Same River, Different Banks · Letters, Landlines and Loud Dinners

Hazırlık Sonrası 10. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

1 Before you read

Make predictions before you read.

1. Look at the title. What do you think 'the same river, different banks' might mean about generations?
2. What is one thing your grandparents' generation did differently from yours?

The Same River, Different Banks

- 1 Every generation likes to believe it invented independence. Grandparents in Türkiye often describe childhoods spent playing football in the street until dark, with no phone to call home and no need for one — the whole neighbourhood, they say, looked after every child. Their grandchildren, meanwhile, grew up with smartphones in their pockets and a constant stream of messages from worried parents. Which generation was really freer is a question that rarely gets a simple answer.
- 2 Sociologists suggest that each generation's outlook is shaped less by personality than by the economic and technological conditions it grows up in. A generation that lived through hardship often values saving money and repairing things rather than replacing them; a generation raised with instant information often values speed, choice and self-expression instead. Neither outlook is wrong — they are simply sensible responses to very different worlds.
- 3 The real danger, researchers argue, isn't the generation gap itself but the assumption that it can't be bridged. Families who regularly talk about their different experiences — rather than judging each other by their own generation's standards — tend to pass down both practical skills and emotional closeness. A grandmother who gets her granddaughter to show her how video calls work, and a granddaughter who asks her grandmother how she once cooked for a family of ten on a tight budget, are both quietly closing the same gap.

230 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is the main idea of the text?
 - a Older generations were always freer than younger ones.
 - b Each generation's outlook is shaped by its own conditions, and the gap can be bridged through mutual sharing.
 - c Technology has made family relationships impossible.
2. According to sociologists, each generation's outlook is shaped by _____ and technological conditions.
3. According to the text, what is the 'real danger' regarding the generation gap?
 - a That grandparents don't understand smartphones
 - b The assumption that the gap can't be bridged
 - c That young people don't want to learn to cook
4. According to the text, one generation's outlook is simply wrong compared to another's.
☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
5. The final paragraph gives an example of a grandmother who gets her granddaughter to show her how _____ work.

3 After you read*Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

1. Do you agree that neither generation's outlook is 'wrong'? Why or why not?

2. Can you think of a skill an older relative could teach you, or one you could teach them?

1 Before you read*Make predictions before you read.*

1. What do you know about how people communicated before mobile phones?

2. Does your family have any rules about phones at meals? What do you think of them?

Letters, Landlines and Loud Dinners

- 1 Merve's grandfather still keeps a box of handwritten letters from his years working abroad in the 1970s. 'We waited weeks for news,' he tells her, 'and every letter felt like an event.' Merve, who video-calls her cousins in Germany every weekend without a second thought, finds the story almost impossible to imagine — yet she notices that her grandfather remembers the exact words of letters he received fifty years ago, while she sometimes forgets a text message within minutes.
- 2 The family's Sunday dinners are where these two worlds collide loudest. Merve's grandmother insists that everyone sit at the table with their phones switched off, a rule she enforces with surprising firmness for someone so soft-spoken otherwise. At first, Merve found the rule old-fashioned and slightly unfair. Over time, though, she noticed that these were the only two hours each week when her whole extended family actually looked at one another while talking.
- 3 Merve's mother, caught between both generations, often acts as a translator of sorts — explaining to her own mother why a video call matters as much as a letter once did, and reminding Merve that patience, not just connection, was something her grandfather's generation had in abundance. Nobody in the family has fully convinced the others that their way is best. What they have managed, slowly, is to borrow a little from each generation and build something that works for all three.

234 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What does Merve's grandfather still keep from his years working abroad?
☐ a Old photographs ☒ b A box of handwritten letters ☐ c Recorded phone calls
 2. Merve's grandmother insists that everyone switch off their _____ at Sunday dinner.
 3. Merve immediately loved her grandmother's no-phones rule at dinner. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
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4. What role does Merve's mother often play between the two generations?
☒ a She ignores both sides completely. ☒ b She acts as a kind of translator between them.
☐ c She always agrees only with her own mother.
 5. By the end of the text, the family has managed to borrow a little from each generation and build something that works for all _____.

3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

1. Whose approach do you find more convincing — the grandfather's patience or Merve's instant connection? Why?

2. What is one 'rule' from an older generation in your own family that you now understand better than you used to?
